

D579

Mental Health Awareness and Education

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

Method © 2026 Erik Daniel Lindquist — Course Mastery Coach, armored drill. Items drafted with AI assistance under his direction.

How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A county behavioral health office, which recently hired a new director, launches a program teaching coping and emotion skills to all seventh graders before any symptoms appear. Which level of prevention is this?

- A. Primary prevention.
- B. Not prevention, because no student is ill yet.
- C. Tertiary prevention.
- D. Secondary prevention.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A clinic gives every adult patient a short depression questionnaire at each annual visit to catch depression early. Which level of prevention is this?

- A. Tertiary prevention.
- B. Primary prevention.
- C. Secondary prevention.
- D. Screening is never a form of prevention.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A community coalition with a \$40,000 budget and a well-known local radio host on its board wants to reduce public stigma toward people with schizophrenia. Which approach has the strongest evidence?

- A. Radio ads read by the host.
- B. Protest campaigns against stigmatizing news stories.
- C. A fact-only brochure about symptoms and causes.
- D. Contact-based events where people living with schizophrenia share their recovery stories and talk with the audience.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A man with depression tells himself he is weak and does not deserve help, so he avoids treatment. Which type of stigma is this?

- A.** Structural stigma.
- B.** Public stigma.
- C.** Self-stigma.
- D.** No stigma at all, since it is always just a symptom.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

A rural county known for its annual fall festival has one psychiatrist for 60,000 residents, and the nearest outpatient clinic is 90 miles away. Most residents have health insurance. Which strategy best targets the main barrier?

- A.** Run an anti-stigma campaign alone.
- B.** Add telehealth services and build behavioral health into local primary care.
- C.** Nothing can be done until a full clinic is built in the county.
- D.** Offer sliding-scale fees.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A woman with bipolar disorder who has worked as a librarian for 15 years still has occasional mood symptoms. She lives on her own, keeps her job, and is working toward goals she chose. How does the recovery model view her?

- A.** She cannot be in recovery until every symptom is gone.
- B.** She is in recovery, because recovery is a self-directed process that can continue with some symptoms.
- C.** She is in recovery only if a clinician chooses her goals for her.
- D.** She is recovered because she has held her job for 15 years.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A coworker at a busy restaurant that just changed owners has been giving away his belongings and says he 'won't be a problem for anyone much longer.' What is the best first response?

- A. Promise to keep whatever he says a secret.
- B. Avoid the word suicide so you do not put the idea in his head.
- C. Ask him directly whether he is thinking about suicide, listen without judgment, and connect him to help such as 988, or emergency services if he is in immediate danger.
- D. Tell him things will get better and change the subject.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which statement about suicide is accurate?

- A. Asking someone directly about suicidal thoughts does not increase risk and can open the door to help.
- B. Asking about suicide makes a person more likely to attempt it.
- C. People who talk about suicide never go through with it.
- D. Only people with a diagnosed mental disorder are at risk.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

At a community health center that recently extended its evening hours, a Spanish-speaking mother describes her son's distress as 'nervios' and asks that her 13-year-old daughter interpret. What is the best practice?

- A. Record 'nervios' as generalized anxiety disorder.
- B. Reschedule for the evening hours.
- C. Let the daughter interpret to save time.
- D. Use a trained medical interpreter and explore what 'nervios' means to this family before labeling it.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

A primary care practice with eight physicians and a new electronic records system finds that most patients it refers to outside therapists for depression never attend a first visit. Which change is most likely to help?

- A.** Embed a behavioral health clinician in the practice, with warm handoffs and a shared care plan.
- B.** Stop screening for depression, since patients do not follow up.
- C.** Replace the electronic records system.
- D.** Give patients a longer list of outside therapists.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A town of 50,000 residents, which recently opened a new community center, had 4,000 residents living with major depression on July 1. Over the next year, 600 new cases were diagnosed among residents who did not have it. What was the point prevalence on July 1?

- A.** 1.2%
- B.** 8%
- C.** 9.2%
- D.** 12.5%

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A town of 50,000 had 4,000 residents with major depression at the start of the year. During the year, 600 new cases developed among people who did not have it. What is the one-year incidence among the population at risk?

- A.** 8%
- B.** 1.2%
- C.** 15%
- D.** About 1.3%

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer A Concept 1

A county behavioral health office, ~~which recently hired a new director,~~ launches a program teaching coping and emotion skills to all seventh graders before any symptoms appear. Which level of prevention is this?

Target word: prevention level **Decides:** Delivered to everyone before onset.

A	Correct	Aims to stop problems before they start in a well population.
B	Inverted operation	Acting before illness is exactly what primary prevention means.
C	Confusion set	Tertiary reduces disability in people already ill.
D	Adjacent category	Secondary finds existing cases early, such as screening.

2. Answer C Concept 1 • transfer

A clinic gives every adult patient a short depression questionnaire at each annual visit to catch depression early. Which level of prevention is this?

Target word: prevention level for screening **Decides:** Detecting existing but unrecognized illness.

A	Confusion set	Tertiary reduces disability after diagnosis.
B	Adjacent category	Primary acts before onset; screening looks for illness already present.
C	Correct	Screening detects disease early, before it worsens.
D	Absolute language	Early detection is the core of secondary prevention.

3. Answer D Concept 2

A community coalition ~~with a \$40,000 budget and a well-known local radio host on its board~~ wants to reduce public stigma toward people with schizophrenia. Which approach has the strongest evidence?

Target word: most effective anti-stigma approach **Decides:** Public stigma responds best to contact.

A	Camouflage	Uses the board member detail; celebrity reach is not contact.
B	Confusion set	Protest can suppress statements but may not change attitudes and can backfire.
C	Dropped element	Education alone has weaker and shorter-lived effects than contact.
D	Correct	Direct contact with lived experience reduces public stigma most reliably.

4. Answer C Concept 2 • transfer

A man with depression tells himself he is weak and does not deserve help, so he avoids treatment. Which type of stigma is this?

Target word: stigma type **Decides:** The person holds the belief about himself.

A	Confusion set	Structural stigma lives in policies and institutions.
B	Adjacent category	Public stigma is others' beliefs about the group.
C	Correct	Internalized negative beliefs about one's own condition.
D	Absolute language	Some self-blame reflects symptoms, but internalized stigma is a recognized barrier.

5. Answer B Concept 3

A rural county ~~known for its annual fall festival~~ has one psychiatrist for 60,000 residents, and the nearest outpatient clinic is 90 miles away. Most residents have health insurance. Which strategy best targets the main barrier?

Target word: strategy for the dominant barrier **Decides:** Workforce shortage and distance; cost is not the issue.

A	Confusion set	Targets acceptability; it adds no providers or access.
B	Correct	Brings care to residents despite few providers and long distances.
C	Absolute language	Telehealth and integration can expand access now.
D	Adjacent category	Targets affordability, but most residents are insured.

6. Answer B Concept 4

A woman with bipolar disorder ~~who has worked as a librarian for 15 years~~ still has occasional mood symptoms. She lives on her own, keeps her job, and is working toward goals she chose. How does the recovery model view her?

Target word: recovery status **Decides:** Meaningful, self-directed life despite some symptoms.

A	Absolute language	That is a cure standard, not the recovery model.
B	Correct	The model centers hope, choice, and community life, not symptom absence.
C	Inverted operation	Recovery is self-directed; the person sets the goals.
D	Camouflage	Job tenure alone does not define recovery.

7. Answer C Concept 5

A coworker at a busy restaurant ~~that just changed owners~~ has been giving away his belongings and says he 'won't be a problem for anyone much longer.' What is the best first response?

Target word: first response to warning signs **Decides:** Clear suicide warning signs.

A	Confusion set	Safety can require involving others; secrecy promises cannot be kept.
B	Inverted operation	Asking directly does not increase risk; avoiding it can miss a crisis.
C	Correct	Direct asking and connection to help is the standard first-aid response.
D	Dropped element	Skips assessing risk and connecting him to help.

8. Answer A Concept 5 • transfer

Which statement about suicide is accurate?

Target word: fact vs. myth **Decides:** Asking directly does not raise risk.

A	Correct	Research does not show that asking plants the idea.
B	Inverted operation	The reverse of the evidence.
C	Absolute language	Talking about suicide is a key warning sign.
D	Confusion set	Many people who die by suicide were never diagnosed.

9. Answer D Concept 6

At a community health center ~~that recently extended its evening hours~~, a Spanish-speaking mother describes her son's distress as 'nervios' and asks that her 13-year-old daughter interpret. What is the best practice?

Target word: culturally appropriate step **Decides:** A child offered as interpreter and a cultural idiom of distress.

A	Confusion set	A cultural idiom is not automatically one diagnosis.
B	Camouflage	The clinic's hours do not decide how to communicate.
C	Adjacent category	Family, especially children, can distort or withhold content and carry an inappropriate burden.
D	Correct	Protects accuracy and privacy and respects the cultural meaning.

10. Answer A Concept 7

A primary care practice ~~with eight physicians and a new electronic records system~~ finds that most patients it refers to outside therapists for depression never attend a first visit. Which change is most likely to help?

Target word: best model to improve follow-through **Decides:** Outside referrals are not being completed.

A	Correct	Integrated care keeps patients in a familiar setting and closes the referral gap.
B	Inverted operation	Removes detection instead of improving access.
C	Camouflage	The records system is not what decides follow-through.
D	Dropped element	More names do not fix the handoff failure.

11. Answer B Concept 8

A town of 50,000 residents, ~~which recently opened a new community center~~, had 4,000 residents living with major depression on July 1. Over the next year, 600 new cases were diagnosed among residents who did not have it. What was the point prevalence on July 1?

Target word: point prevalence **Decides:** Existing cases on July 1 over total population.

A	Confusion set	600 / 50,000 uses new cases, which describe incidence, not prevalence.
B	Correct	$4,000 / 50,000 = 0.08 = 8\%$.
C	Adjacent category	Adds the later new cases; that approaches period prevalence, not the July 1 point.
D	Inverted operation	Divides population by cases ($50,000 / 4,000 = 12.5$) instead of cases by population.

12. Answer D Concept 8 · transfer

A town of 50,000 had 4,000 residents with major depression at the start of the year. During the year, 600 new cases developed among people who did not have it. What is the one-year incidence among the population at risk?

Target word: incidence **Decides:** Population at risk = $50,000 - 4,000 = 46,000$.

A	Confusion set	That is the starting prevalence.
B	Dropped element	600 / 50,000 leaves the existing cases in the denominator; they are not at risk.
C	Wrong stem number	600 / 4,000 divides by existing cases, not people at risk.
D	Correct	$600 / 46,000 = 0.0130$, about 1.3%.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owled.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	4	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	1	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	6	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	6	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	5	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	10	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	4	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Levels of prevention	Primary prevention stops problems before onset; secondary finds them early (screening); tertiary reduces disability and supports recovery once illness is established.	Calling screening primary prevention because it happens before treatment.	Whether the target group is well, undiagnosed, or already ill.
2	Types of stigma and what reduces it	Stigma is public, self (internalized), or structural; contact with people who have lived experience reduces public stigma more than facts alone.	Relying on fact sheets or protest alone, or missing self-stigma.	Who holds the negative belief: the public, the person, or institutions.
3	Matching strategies to access barriers	Identify which barrier dominates (availability, affordability, accessibility, acceptability) and pick a strategy aimed at that barrier.	Applying a cost or stigma fix when the barrier is distance or workforce shortage.	Specific facts about providers, distance, insurance, or attitudes.
4	The recovery model	Recovery is a self-directed process of living a meaningful life in the community, and it can occur while some symptoms persist.	Equating recovery with the total absence of symptoms.	A person working toward chosen goals despite ongoing symptoms.
5	Suicide risk response	When warning signs appear, ask directly about suicide, listen without judgment, and connect to help (such as the 988 line or emergency services if danger is immediate); asking does not plant the idea.	Avoiding the word suicide for fear of causing it, or promising secrecy.	Giving away belongings or talk of being a burden.
6	Culture in mental health care	Use trained interpreters, not family members, and explore culturally specific ways of describing distress before labeling them.	Using a child as interpreter or mapping a cultural term straight onto a diagnosis.	A culture-bound description of distress and a family member offering to translate.
7	Integrated behavioral health	Placing behavioral health staff inside primary care, with warm handoffs and shared care plans, improves follow-through compared with outside referral.	Thinking a longer referral list solves no-shows.	Referred patients never reach the outside therapist.
8	Prevalence vs. incidence	Prevalence = existing cases ÷ population at a time; incidence = new cases over a period ÷ population at risk.	Using new cases for prevalence, or the whole population as the incidence denominator.	Existing cases and new cases in the same stem.

Course scope (public description): Mental Health Awareness and Education is designed to help students recognize mental disorders, improve access to mental health services, support recovery, and lower the rate of death, disease, and disability among those with mental illnesses. Topics include mental health education programs, mental health stigmas, cultural diversity in mental health, and barriers to mental health care and strategies to overcome those barriers. Students will analyze these topics from the vantage point of a community

mental health perspective. There are no prerequisites for this course.